

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

How Learning to Read Changes Lives

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 16

NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS - Why literacy matters

No.	Sentence
1	Reading helps with ordinary tasks, such as checking product _____ while shopping.
2	A UN report estimates that _____ adults worldwide cannot read or write.
3	In coastal towns, regular _____ forces families to move, making school difficult for children.
4	The Friendship Project teaches reading and writing to _____.
5	Before learning to write, one learner used her _____ instead of signing her name.
6	The project is _____ for learners.
7	At Readeasy, trained volunteers teach adult learners _____, rather than in groups.
8	One learner who could not read before is now working through the _____.

11 **Why does the opening discussion describe reading as an essential skill?**

- A It allows people to follow printed information used in everyday life.
- B It enables people to finish journeys to work more quickly.
- C It helps people choose which news reports are most reliable.
- D It helps people judge product quality without asking shop staff.

12 **What is presented as the main reason many people grow up unable to read, with coastal Bangladesh given as an example?**

- A Their families prefer lessons at home to formal classes.
- B They do not attend school, sometimes because moving disrupts education.
- C Their schools concentrate on counting rather than reading.
- D They begin work before they have learnt to write their names.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **How did Rashida say her children reacted to her inability to read and write?**
- A They were worried that she would stop keeping household accounts.
 - B They were relieved that she could already sign official papers.
 - C They felt embarrassed that their mother could not read or write.
 - D They became interested in joining her lessons themselves.
- 14 **What does the Bangladeshi learner's account suggest about managing her money after the lessons?**
- A She can work out in advance what every purchase will cost.
 - B She can provide financial advice to other learners.
 - C She now relies on her children to record her expenses.
 - D She can make informed checks that may protect her from being cheated.
- 15 **How is the English project presented in relation to the Bangladeshi one?**
- A It serves a different country where adults also face literacy difficulties.
 - B It offers the same group lessons to women and girls in coastal towns.
 - C It is described as replacing the Bangladeshi project's approach.
 - D It serves adults who already read but need help with maths.
- 16 **How did Peter's childhood hearing difficulties affect his education, according to the discussion?**
- A They led his family to keep him away from school.
 - B They caused him to lose interest in learning after school.
 - C They made it harder for him to keep up at school, and he did not learn to read.
 - D They meant that he learnt reading only through written college lessons.
- 17 **How did the unsuccessful college attempts affect Peter's belief about learning to read?**
- A He thought independent reading was unnecessary once a neighbour could help.
 - B He thought the college courses had prepared him to read letters.
 - C He blamed only his hearing difficulties for the unsuccessful courses.
 - D He had begun to doubt that learning to read would work for him.
- 18 **What does Peter's later reading of the Harry Potter books most clearly illustrate?**
- A The books were the teaching materials used in every Readeasy lesson.
 - B The lessons have enabled him to read for himself after earlier difficulties.
 - C His childhood hearing problems have now completely disappeared.
 - D He has finished all the books since joining Readeasy.